

Module 7: Alpha Heating and Thermal-Profile Evolution

Physics-Note Scaffold for Kinetic_MHD_PINN

Module boundary, mathematical anchor, interfaces, verification obligations, and surrogate role

Purpose of this scaffold. Convert confined energetic-particle power into electron/ion heating and evolve reduced density, temperature, pressure, and Alfvén-speed profiles. This document establishes the module boundary before a full derivation or implementation is written. Statements labeled as planned work are not claims of a completed solver.

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Symbols and acronyms used in this document

Symbol / acronym	Name	Meaning in this document
AE	Alfvén eigenmode	A discrete shear-Alfvén mode that can interact resonantly with energetic particles.
EP	Energetic particle	Fusion-born alpha particle, neutral-beam ion, or other suprathermal population.
MHD	Magnetohydrodynamics	Fluid description of the bulk plasma and magnetic field.
PINN	Physics-informed neural network	Neural approximation trained with governing-equation and boundary-condition residuals.
ψ	Flux-surface coordinate	Reduced radial coordinate labeling nested magnetic surfaces when such surfaces exist.
f_f	Energetic-particle distribution	Reduced or full phase-space distribution of the fast-ion population.
ω	Mode frequency	Real oscillation frequency unless a complex convention is stated.
γ	Growth rate	Positive for instability and negative for damping under the adopted convention.
U	Coupled state	Collection of fields and reduced variables exchanged among modules.

1 Scope

Module purpose. Convert confined energetic-particle power into electron/ion heating and evolve reduced density, temperature, pressure, and Alfvén-speed profiles.

Upstream dependency. Modules 2, 3, and 6.

Primary input contract. deposited alpha/NBI power, loss power, transport coefficients, radiation losses, and initial profiles.

Primary output contract. $T_i(\psi, t)$, $T_e(\psi, t)$, $p(\psi, t)$, $\rho(\psi, t)$, $v_A(\psi, t)$, and fusion-source updates.

2 Mathematical starting point

The first governing-equation anchor for this module is

$$\frac{3}{2} \frac{\partial(n_s T_s)}{\partial t} = -\frac{1}{V'} \frac{\partial}{\partial \psi} (V' Q_s) + P_{\alpha \rightarrow s} + P_{\text{NBI} \rightarrow s} - P_{\text{loss}, s}. \quad (2.1)$$

A full version of this note must define every normalization, sign convention, coordinate system, boundary condition, initial condition, closure, and approximation used to turn this anchor into a solvable model.

3 Planned fidelity progression

1. Analytic or manufactured limit with a known qualitative or quantitative solution.
2. Reduced executable model with explicit assumptions and independent verification.
3. Coupled interface test using synthetic upstream data.
4. Higher-fidelity or external-code comparison when a trusted reference becomes available.

4 Numerical-method obligations

The implementation note for this module must specify:

- state representation and units;
- spatial, temporal, velocity-space, or spectral discretization as applicable;
- solver and convergence criteria;
- conservation, positivity, symmetry, and invariant checks;
- input/output schema and interpolation/remapping policy;
- uncertainty sources and failure flags.

5 Physics-inspired surrogate opportunity

Neural operator for real-time profile evolution constrained by energy conservation and transport equations.

A surrogate is acceptable only if its validation includes out-of-distribution tests, physical-residual checks, conserved-quantity error, and comparison against a conventional solver or trusted reference. A low data error alone is insufficient.

6 Coupling role

This module exchanges data through typed project state products rather than direct access to another solver's internal arrays. Coupling code belongs in Module 8. Any feedback edge introduced here must identify its physical mechanism, direction, natural timescale, units, and whether the exchange is explicit, lagged, or iterated.

7 Verification checklist

1. Confirm dimensional consistency and adopted normalization.
2. Recover at least one analytic or manufactured limit.
3. Demonstrate convergence with resolution or basis size.
4. Quantify sensitivity to boundary/initial conditions and closure parameters.
5. Verify relevant particle, energy, momentum, or phase-space budgets.
6. Record known nonphysical regimes and solver failure behavior.

8 Planned references

The completed note should cite primary literature for the governing model, a trusted numerical-method reference, and benchmark or validation sources. References will be selected when this module becomes an active implementation target.